

Aging and People with Disabilities

Number: APD-PT-25-018

Authorized by: Jane-ellen Weidanz

Issue date: 10/10/2025

Subject: Animal care and incidental activities as part of In-Home Services

Transmitting (check the box that best applies)

- ☐ New policy ☒ Policy change ☒ Policy clarification ☐ Executive letter
☐ Administrative Rule ☐ Manual update ☐ Other:

Applies to (check all that apply):

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ All ODHS employees | ☐ County DD Program Managers |
| ☒ Aging and People with Disabilities | ☐ Developmental Disabilities Services |
| ☒ Area Agencies on Aging: Type A and B | ☐ Self-Sufficiency Programs |
| ☐ Child Welfare Division | ☐ Support Service Brokerage Directors |
| ☐ Children's Intensive In Home Services | ☐ Stabilization and Crisis Unit |
| ☐ Children's Residential Services | ☐ Other (please specify): Enter Text |

Policy/rule title: In-Home Services rule (OAR 411-030), Homecare Workers Enrolled in the Consumer-Employed Provider Program rule (OAR 411-031-0040).

Policy/rule numbers: OAR 411-015-0005(42), OAR 411-015-0006, 0007, OAR 411-030-0070(3)(11), OAR 411-031-0040(2)(7), OAR 411-034-0070(2)(3)

Release number:

Effective date: Upon Release

Expiration date:

References:

Web address:

Discussion/interpretation

This policy transmittal explains how limited animal care, as well as other incidental activities (defined below), may be provided by Homecare Workers (HCWs) or In-Home Care Agencies (IHCA) for individuals receiving in-home services who need this level of support from their provider(s).

Incidental activities are brief, simple chores that an HCW or IHCA may complete during their shift that may not be stated on the task list. They must:

- Be tied to the individual's documented ADL/IADL need.
- Support the individual's health, safety, or home environment.
- Benefit the individual only (not others in the household).
- Not add extra or exceptional service hours.

In addition:

- ADL/IADL tasks always take priority over incidental activities.
- Providers are not required to perform incidental activities they are uncomfortable with (e.g., due to physical limitations, safety concerns, or preference).
- Exceptions are not granted beyond the listed parameters.

Implementation/transition instructions

Limited Animal Care:

Assistance with an individual's animals in their home is permitted only when directly related to an assessed ADL or IADL need and documented in the task list.

1) Allowable Animal Care

Providers may help only when care relates to the individual's ADL/IADL needs, including

- Assisting the individual while walking their animal when the individual cannot safely walk the animal on their own.
- Cleaning, disinfecting, and disposing of indoor waste.
- Putting food or water in a dish.
- Shopping for animal supplies.
- Letting the animal in/out of the home.
- Giving oral medicine in food or water.
- Accompanying the individual to veterinary appointments when ADL/IADL support is needed.
 - The individual must plan provider hours to cover travel time and time at the veterinary appointment.
 - Mileage reimbursement requires case manager authorization.

2) Non-Allowable Animal Care

Providers may not:

- Care for animals that do not live in the individual's home.

- Pick up feces outside the home unless the animal waste poses a health hazardous to the individual or others entering/exiting the home.
- Care for animals outside the home (e.g., chickens, farm animals).

3) Health & Safety Note

If animals regularly soil the home and create unsafe conditions, providers must notify the case manager and submit the Online Health and Safety Reporting Form ([APD-AR-24-010](#)).

Change on Task List form:

The task list (SDS 598N) will be modified in a future Oregon ACCESS release to include updated and additional information at the end of the document (the release date is currently being determined). The update is provided below.

NOTE: The task list reflects the authorized tasks, hours, and mileage for the provider. The hours and mileage may be prorated if the provider is not authorized to work for an entire pay period.

A pay period consists of two consecutive work weeks. A work week is defined as Sunday 12:00 a.m. through Saturday 11:59 p.m. This does not apply to in-home care agencies.

Tasks and hours authorized on this task list are for the benefit of the individual only, and do not include care for others in the household. This includes but is not limited to; childcare or chores outside the home (i.e., yard work).

Providers may offer minimal care for an individual's indoor animal(s) but are not required to do so. This does not include exercise without the individual present, outdoor cleanup unless necessary for the safety and health of the individual, care for farm animals, or extensive time with multiple animals.

- Oregon Home Care Commission

- Have a problem with your pay? Contact your local office and complete this Late or Partial Payment form:
<https://forms.office.com/g/MTG4yH330b>



- Need to report an unsafe or unhealthy workplace, dangerous behavior or threats of harm or criminal activity? Contact your local office and complete this Health and Safety Report form:
<https://forms.office.com/g/nA2dbbqRh4>



Local/branch action required

Local office (LO) supervisors should share this information with staff and individuals receiving in-home services. The APD Training Unit (TUFSS) will incorporate incidental activities into training modules for case managers and other staff as needed. The Oregon Home Care Commission (OHCC) and Carewell (SEIU) will also include this information in their training for homecare workers.

Central office action required

This information will be posted on the In-Home Services page of the APD Case Management Tools and Resources website and shared with IHCA leadership. TUFSS will be supported in developing any necessary training materials on this topic.

Reviewed by impacted parties? ☒ Yes ☐ No

If yes, reviewed by: OPS and ODDS

Filing instructions:

If you have any questions, please contact:

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